ERA 11

# The End of Reconstruction

*1865 – 1877*

Sharecropping · the KKK · the Compromise of 1877

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

Why did Reconstruction fail to secure lasting equality for freedpeople?

**KEY TERMS**

Sharecropping · the Ku Klux Klan · Redeemer governments · the Compromise of 1877

**ALIGNED TO**

CED Topic 5.11 · AMSCO Ch. 5.11

FREEDOM WITHOUT LAND

# The Economic Question

# '40 Acres and a Mule'?

HOPE

## Land for the Freed

Freedpeople expected land to build independent lives.

→

PROMISE

## Sherman's Land

40,000 settle on confiscated coastal land.

→

REVERSAL

## Land Returned

Johnson restores the land to former owners.

→

RESULT

## Landless

Most freedpeople are left with no land of their own.

# The Sharecropping Trap

NO LAND

### Work Another's Land

Landless families farm a planter's land for a share of the crop.

→

ON CREDIT

### Debt to the Store

They buy seed and supplies on credit at high interest.

→

THE TRAP

### Endless Debt

Debt exceeds their share—binding them to the land year after year.

SECTION

# Southern Backlash

# The Ku Klux Klan



- The **Ku Klux Klan**, founded in 1866, used terror to restore white supremacy.
- Klansmen beat, lynched, and murdered Black citizens and their allies—especially at election time.
- Congress struck back with the **Force Acts**, but violence persisted.

SECTION

# Reconstruction Collapses

# Why Reconstruction Ended

I

## Northern Fatigue

War memories faded and the North lost the will to enforce it.

II

## 'Redeemer' Governments

White conservative Democrats retook Southern statehouses.

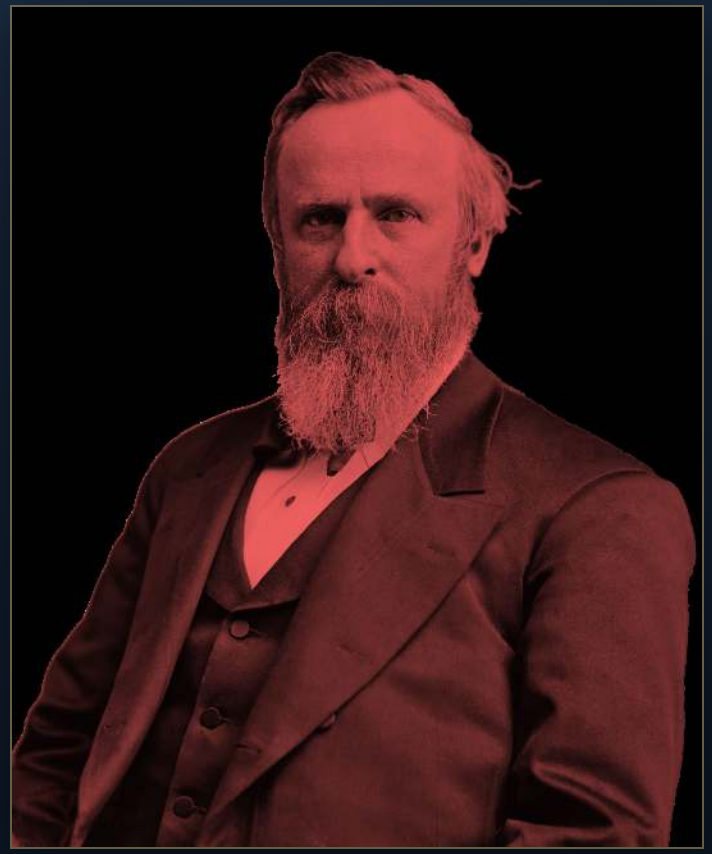
III

## Terror & the Courts

Klan violence and hostile Supreme Court rulings gutted Black rights.

# The Compromise of 1877

- The disputed 1876 election was settled by a backroom deal.
- Republican **Rutherford B. Hayes** became president.
- In return, federal troops left the South—ending **Reconstruction**.



# The Long Shadow

I

## Segregation

**Jim Crow** laws would soon enforce racial separation.

II

## Disenfranchisement

Black Southerners were stripped of the vote for generations.

III

## An Unfinished Revolution

The promise of equal citizenship went unfulfilled for a century.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

# The End of Reconstruction

1. Without land, most freedpeople fell into **sharecropping** and debt.
2. White **terror (the KKK)** and 'Redeemer' governments rolled back Black political power.
3. The **Compromise of 1877** withdrew federal troops and ended Reconstruction—opening the door to **Jim Crow segregation**.

DISCUSS & APPLY

# The End of Reconstruction

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

**CAUSATION**

Explain how **sharecropping** trapped freedpeople in a cycle of poverty and debt.

**ARGUMENTATION**

Did Reconstruction **fail**, or was it a partial success later undone? Make and defend a claim.

**CONTINUITY & CHANGE**

How did the **end of Reconstruction** shape race relations in the South for the next century?

Up next — **Class 33: The Gilded Age** (industry, big business & monopoly)